The Twitter attack discussed earlier violated relationship integrity in several ways. It directly compromised the relationship between Twitter's administrators and the system itself while also undermining Twitter's relationships with the verified account holders whose accounts were hijacked. Ultimately, the attack harmed the indirect relationships between those verified account holders and their followers, who trusted Twitter's assurance that tweets genuinely represented the intended authors. More broadly, the attack led to brand damage and loss of customer trust with attendant financial implications.

Figure 3.2 shows the chain reaction that happens when the integrity of just a few relationships is broken. In this case, the integrity of the relationship that Twitter's administrative system had with employees was compromised. This led to a loss of integrity for verified accounts, which broke the technical confidence that people could place in the system. Note that their confidence was limited by the design and strength of Twitter's internal controls and they were vulnerable in ways they didn't understand. People were deceived, leading to financial loss due to the cryptocurrency scam, account lockdowns with the attendant loss of service, and ultimately, the loss of trust in Twitter to limit the spread of misinformation.